Story of the Flood (*Atraḫasīs*) – Middle Babylonian Ug_2: “At The Start Of The New Moon, At The Beginning Of The Month”

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- Source: eBL corpus – https://www.ebl.lmu.de/corpus/L/1/1/Middle%20Babylonian/Ug%E2%82%82
- API: https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/1/chapters/Middle%20Babylonian/Ug%E2%82%82/display
- Edition:
- Translation:
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Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (| metrical foot, || caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

1

- **N:** ina pī (|) bibli || ina rēš (|) arhi
- **T:** At the start of the New Moon, at the beginning of the month,

- **L:** *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *pī* ← pû I “(also OB)”; *bibli* ← biblu I “pl. m. & f. the (action of) bringing”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *rēš* ← rēšu I “head”; *arhi* ← warhu I “”
- **Note:** On the reading *rēš arḫi*, see [NABU1996-13]. According to [wasserman2020flood: 89], the line reflects the tradition that the Flood started when the moon was invisible (on which see [RN1780: 209–210]), present in the Old Babylonian version (OB II 439b: *ana ūm warḫim*, “by the day of the New Moon”), in the SB version (SB III 92: *[... u_2-b]i-il ar-hu* “[...] the month rea[ched its end],” and in MB Priv 50 (*[... i-na u_4-mi-im] e#-ṭi#-i[m (x x x)]*, “[... on the] dimming [day]”). Unlike these traditions where the Flood starts on the new moon, Wasserman notes that this text presents the Flood as nearly finished on that date.

```
UgaMB1 o 1. i-na pi₂-i bi-ib-li i-na re-eš ITI
```

2

- **N:** ēa | bēlu | rabû || ina šuttīya | izziza(m)-ma
- **T:** Ea, the great lord, appeared to me in a dream,
- **L:** *ēa* ← Ea I; *bēlu* ← bēlu I “lord”; *rabû* ← rabû I “big”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *šuttīya* ← šuttu I “pl. *šunātu(m)* dream š. *naṭālu*, *amāru* etc. to have a dream, to...”; *izziza(m)-ma* ← izuzzu I “to stand”
- **Note:** The collation is reported in [NABU2008-70], where the reading of the word is also discussed.

```
UgaMB1 o 2–3a. {d}e₂-a be-lu GAL i-na MAŠ₂*.<GE₆>-ia | iz-zi-za-ma
```

3

- **N:** liqē-ma | marra | u haṣṣinna
- **T:** (Saying:) “Take a spade and a copper axe,
- **L:** *liqē-ma* ← leqû II “to take, take over”; *marra* ← marru II “shovel, spade Bab. also as symbol of Marduk and Nabû”; *u* ← u I “and, but, also”; *haṣṣinna* ← haṣṣinnu I “Mari, NB pl. f. axe of copper, silver, gold etc.”
- **Note:** Wasserman notes that the mention of a copper axe to carve a window suggests that hte boat is made of wood, and not of rope or reeds, as in other traditions ([wasserman2020flood: 89–90]).

```
UgaMB1 o 3b–4a. li-qe₂-ma {giš}mar-ra | u₃ ha-ṣi-in-na{urudu!}
```

4

- **N:** apta | epuš | ana muhhi
- **T:** “Open a window at the top,

- **L:** *apta* ← aptu I “pl. *apātu* window, window opening Ass., O/jB in house, NB in sluice”; *epuš* ← epēšu II “to do”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *muhhi* ← muhhu I “skull”

```
UgaMB1 o 4b-5a. ap-ta | e-pu-uš a-na muh-hi
```

5-6

- **N:** uššir | iṣṣūram-ma || līmurakka | kibra
- **T:** “Release a bird, that she find the shore for you!”
- **L:** *uššir* ← wašāru I “~ to sink down”; *iṣṣūram-ma* ← iṣṣūru I “occas. f.”; *līmurakka* ← amāru I “to see”; *kibra* ← kibru I “pl. m. & f. bank, shore, rim of river, canal, sea, as safe place”

```
UgaMB1 o 5b-6. uš-ši-ir | MUŠEN-ma li-mu-rak-ka kib-ra
```

7

- **N:** aqūl | anāku
- **T:** I paid attention
- **L:** *aqūl* ← qâlu I “to pay attention”; *anāku* ← anāku I “I”

```
UgaMB1 o 7a. a-qu-ul a-na-ku
```

8

- **N:** ina qibīt(i) (|) ēa | bēlīya | māliki | rabî
- **T:** To the words of Ea, my lord, the great counselor.
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *qibīt(i)* ← qibītu I “speech”; *ēa* ← Ea I; *bēlīya* ← bēlu I “lord”; *māliki* ← māliku I “adviser, counsellor”; *rabî* ← rabû I “big”

```
UgaMB1 o 7b-8. i-na qi₂-bi-ti | {d}e₂-a be-li-ia ma-li-ki GAL
```

9

- **N:** alqē-ma | marra | u haṣṣinna
- **T:** I took a spade and a copper axe,
- **L:** *alqē-ma* ← leqû II “to take, take over”; *marra* ← marru II “shovel, spade Bab. also as symbol of Marduk and Nabû”; *u* ← u I “and, but, also”; *haṣṣinna* ← haṣṣinnu I “Mari, NB pl. f. axe of copper, silver, gold etc.”

```
UgaMB1 o 9. al-qe₃-ma {giš}MAR u₃ ha-ṣi-na{urudu}
```

10

- **N:** apta | ēpuš | ana muhhīya
- **T:** I opened a window at the top,
- **L:** *apta* ← aptu I “pl. *apātu* window, window opening Ass., O/jB in house, NB in sluice”; *ēpuš* ← epēšu II “to do”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *muhhīya* ← muhhu I “skull”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XI" 137

```
UgaMB1 o 10. ap-ta e-pu-uš a-na muh-hi-ia
```

11

- **N:** dannata | kappī | summata
- **T:** Strong of wings, a dove
- **L:** *dannata* ← dannu I “NA f. also *da''atu* strong, powerful, mighty, great of god, king,...”; *kappī* ← kappu I “wing O/jB of bird, ant, god, statue”; *summata* ← summatu I “(female) dove, pigeon”

```
UgaMB1 o 11. dan-na-ta kap-pi₂ su-ma-ta{mušen!}
```

12

- **N:** umaššir | illik | itūram-ma
- **T:** I released; she soared forth and returned to me.
- **L:** *umaššir* ← wašāru I “~ to sink down”; *illik* ← alāku I “to go”; *itūram-ma* ← târu I “to turn, return”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XI" 148-150

```
UgaMB1 b.e. 1. u₂-maš-ši-ir il-lik i-tu₂-ra-ma
```

13

- **N:** ušānih! | kappīša
- **T:** She had exhausted her wings.
- **L:** *ušānih!* ← anāhu I “to be(come) tired”; *kappīša* ← kappu I “wing O/jB of bird, ant, god, statue”
- **Note:** A collation is reported in [NABU2008-70]; “*u₂-ša-tik₂*” (sic, presumably for *tik*). [cavigneaux2007oiseaux: 319] reads *u₂-ša-ni-hi* (“elle revint à bout de forces (litt. “elle avait épuisé ses ailes”)”; cf. also [darshan2021calendrical: 510]: “She exhausted her wings”); [RN88: 201] reads *u₂-ša-kil₂* (“j’en avais exécuté artistiquement”). Wassermann ([wasserman2020flood: 90]) reads also *u₂-ša-ni-ŋi* instead of the expected ventive *ušāniŋa*.

```
UgaMB1 b.e. 2. u₂-ša-ni!-ih! kap-pi₂-ša
```

14

- **N:** ašnī-ma | anāku || kumâ | umaššir-ma
- **T:** Once again, I released a pelican.
- **L:** *ašnī-ma* ← šanû III “to do twice, do for a second time”; *anāku* ← anāku I “I”; *kumâ* ← kumû I “(a water bird, phps.) pelican jB”; *umaššir-ma* ← wašāru I “~ to sink down”
- **Note:** On the *kumû*-bird, see [cavigneaux2007oiseaux: 320]: “ce doit être un oiseau aquatique apte à se poser dans un terrain encore inondé, mais par une faible épaisseur d’eau.” [RN754: 24–243] and, following him, [wasserman2020flood: 90], identify the *kumû* bird as a crane (see also [darshan2021calendrical: 510], who identifies it as a “water-bird,” “perhaps a pelican”).
- **Note:** The collation is reported in [NABU2008-70].
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XI" 151

```
UgaMB1 r 1. aš-ni-ma a-na-ku ku-ma-a{mušen!(RI*)} u₂-ma-ši-ir-ma
```